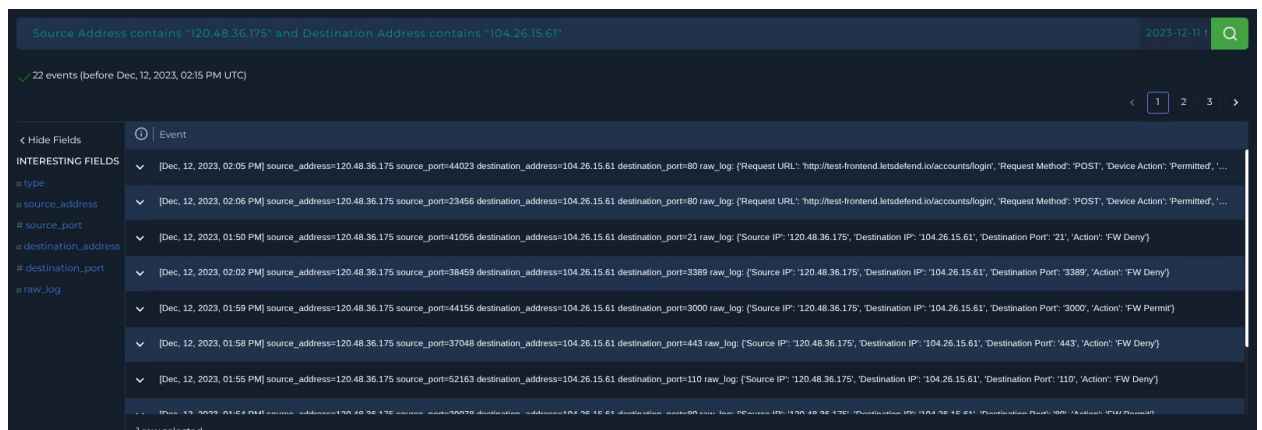


Event Information:

EventID :
208
Event Time :
Dec, 12, 2023, 02:15 PM
Rule :
SOC246 - Forced Authentication Detected
Level :
Security Analyst
Source IP :
120.48.36.175
Destination IP :
104.26.15.61
Host :
WebServer_Test
Request URL :
<http://test-frontend.letsdefend.io/accounts/login>
Request Method :
POST
Device Action :
Permitted
Alert Trigger Reason :
Multiple POST requests were soon seen from the same IP to the fixed URI "/accounts/login".

Analysis Steps:

Logs were searched with IP 120[.]48.36.175 as the source and WebServer_Test IP 104[.]26.15.61 as the destination in the relevant time-frame yielding 22 events. The attacker can be seen systematically testing various ports such as FTP (21), SSH (22), Telnet (23), SMTP (25), and RDP (3389). The firewall correctly blocked most of these, but it permitted traffic on port 80 (HTTP) and port 3000.



Source Address contains "120.48.36.175" and Destination Address contains "104.26.15.61"		2023-12-11 1
22 events (before Dec, 12, 2023, 02:15 PM UTC)		
1 2 3		
< Hide Fields	Event	
INTERESTING FIELDS		
a type	[Dec, 12, 2023, 02:05 PM] source_address=120.48.36.175 source_port=44023 destination_address=104.26.15.61 destination_port=80 raw_log: {"Request URL": "http://test-frontend.letsdefend.io/accounts/login", "Request Method": "POST", "Device Action": "Permitted", ...}	
a source_address	[Dec, 12, 2023, 02:06 PM] source_address=120.48.36.175 source_port=23456 destination_address=104.26.15.61 destination_port=80 raw_log: {"Request URL": "http://test-frontend.letsdefend.io/accounts/login", "Request Method": "POST", "Device Action": "Permitted", ...}	
# source_port	[Dec, 12, 2023, 01:50 PM] source_address=120.48.36.175 source_port=41056 destination_address=104.26.15.61 destination_port=21 raw_log: {"Source IP": "120.48.36.175", "Destination IP": "104.26.15.61", "Destination Port": "21", "Action": "FW Deny"}	
a destination_address	[Dec, 12, 2023, 02:02 PM] source_address=120.48.36.175 source_port=38459 destination_address=104.26.15.61 destination_port=3389 raw_log: {"Source IP": "120.48.36.175", "Destination IP": "104.26.15.61", "Destination Port": "3389", "Action": "FW Deny"}	
# destination_port	[Dec, 12, 2023, 01:59 PM] source_address=120.48.36.175 source_port=44156 destination_address=104.26.15.61 destination_port=3000 raw_log: {"Source IP": "120.48.36.175", "Destination IP": "104.26.15.61", "Destination Port": "3000", "Action": "FW Permit"}	
a raw_log	[Dec, 12, 2023, 01:58 PM] source_address=120.48.36.175 source_port=37048 destination_address=104.26.15.61 destination_port=443 raw_log: {"Source IP": "120.48.36.175", "Destination IP": "104.26.15.61", "Destination Port": "443", "Action": "FW Deny"}	
	[Dec, 12, 2023, 01:55 PM] source_address=120.48.36.175 source_port=52163 destination_address=104.26.15.61 destination_port=110 raw_log: {"Source IP": "120.48.36.175", "Destination IP": "104.26.15.61", "Destination Port": "110", "Action": "FW Deny"}	
1 row selected		

Between 02:05 PM and 02:15 PM, the proxy logs show a rapid series of POST requests. Attempting a variety of different common default login credentials of root, admin, etc. with passwords like 123456.

At 02:15 PM. The action is recorded as User Login Successful for the admin account using the credentials Username=admin&Password=password.

Event	
source_address	120.48.36.175
source_port	29045
destination_address	104.26.15.61
destination_port	80
time	Dec, 12, 2023, 02:15 PM
Raw Log	
Request URL	http://test-frontend.letsdefend.io/accounts/login
Request Method	POST
Device Action	Permitted
User-Agent	Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; rv: 78.0) Gecko/20100101 Firefox/78.0
Credentials	Username=admin&Password=password

This event was followed by:

Event	
source_address	120.48.36.175
source_port	0
destination_address	104.26.15.61
destination_port	0
time	Dec, 12, 2023, 02:15 PM
Raw Log	
Date	Dec, 12, 2023, 02:15 PM
source	120.48.36.175
dest	104.26.15.61
admin	admin
action	User Login Successful

The offending IP is not in our CTI database and is external to the organisation. No emails have been received indicating penetration testing involving the IP for the relevant time period. VirusTotal indicates it is a Chinese address associated with 120[.]48.36.175 AS 38365 (Beijing Baidu Netcom Science and Technology Co., Ltd.). 4/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious.

4

/ 91

Community Score

4/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious

CN

Last Analysis Date
17 days ago

Reanalyze

More

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

COMMUNITY 3

Join our Community

 and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to [automate checks](#).

Crowdsourced context

HIGH 0

MEDIUM 0

LOW 1

INFO 1

SUCCESS 0

SSH bruteforce Attackers [2023-09-20]

 - according to source ArcSight Threat Intelligence - 2 years ago

Source: alexwast VirusTotal Link: <https://www.virustotal.com/gui/ip-address/120.48.36.175/detection> Abuse IPDB Link: <https://www.abuseipdb.com/check/120.48.36.175>

Find more information on CrowdSec CTI

 - according to source CrowdSec - 2 years ago

Behaviors: SSH Bruteforce / TELNET Bruteforce

Security vendors' analysis

Do you want to automate checks?

ADMINUSLabs

Malicious

BitDefender

Phishing

Chong Lua Dao

Malicious

G Data

Phishing

alphaMountain.ai

Suspicious

Abusix

Clean

On AbuseIPDB this IP was reported 2,583 times with a 0% confidence of abuse.

120.48.36.175 was found in our database!

This IP was reported 2,583 times. Confidence of Abuse is 0%:

0%

ISP

Beijing Baidu Netcom Science and Technology Co., Ltd.

Usage Type

Data Center/Web Hosting/Transit

ASN

[AS38365](#)

Domain Name

baidu.com

Country

 China

City

Beijing, Beijing

Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a successful True Positive.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a successful True Positive brute-force authentication attack against the host WebServer_Test (104[.]26.15.61). An external threat actor systematically scanned the perimeter and then executed a credential stuffing attack against the web login portal. The attacker successfully compromised the admin account.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC246 - Forced Authentication Detected
- **Target Host:** WebServer_Test (104[.]26.15.61)
- **Attacker IP:** 120[.]48.36.175
- **Device Action:** Permitted

Analysis and Evidence

- **Reconnaissance:** Log analysis indicates the attacker initially conducted a port scan across the host, testing FTP (21), SSH (22), Telnet (23), SMTP (25), and RDP (3389). The firewall blocked these but allowed traffic on ports 80 and 3000.
- **Attack Execution:** Having found port 80 open, the attacker initiated a rapid series of HTTP POST requests to `hxxp://test-frontend[.]letsdefend[.]io/accounts/login` between 02:05 PM and 02:15 PM. They cycled through common default usernames and weak passwords.
- **Success Confirmation:** OS application logs confirm that at exactly 02:15 PM, a "User Login Successful" event was generated for the admin account. Correlating this with proxy logs confirms the attacker breached the system using the payload `Username=admin&Password=password`.

Threat Intelligence

- **OSINT (Infrastructure):** The attacking IP (120[.]48.36.175) is an external address assigned to Beijing Baidu Netcom Science and Technology Co., Ltd. (AS 38365) in China.
- **Reputation:** VirusTotal flags the IP as malicious with 4/91 vendor detections. AbuseIPDB shows 2,583 reports for this IP, indicating a high volume of automated scanning and brute-forcing activity.
- **Internal Correlation:** The IP is not in the internal CTI database, and no authorised Red Team penetration testing was scheduled involving this IP during the relevant time-frame.

Actions Taken

1. Analysed network and proxy logs to identify a multi-port scan followed by an active credential stuffing attack.
2. Correlated application (OS) logs with proxy logs to verify the brute-force attempt successfully compromised the admin account.
3. Verified the attacker infrastructure via OSINT (VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB), confirming the IP is associated with known threat activity originating from China.
4. Declared the alert a successful True Positive compromise and escalated.

Let's Defend Result

SOC246 - Forced Authentication Detected

True Positive (+5 Point)

Do You Need Tier 2 Escalation? (+5 Point)

Was the Attack Successful? (+5 Point)

What Is the Direction of Traffic? (+5 Point)

Check If It Is a Planned Test (+5 Point)

What Is The Attack Type? (+5 Point)

Is Traffic Malicious? (+5 Point)